

These two chips reinforced their position in the game. Subsequently, they produced two more chips at SCL, further establishing their presence.

In the second phase, they shifted their focus to security and hypervisor mode. Simultaneously, they identified the need for startup companies to build an ecosystem in the country.

As a visionary academician, Prof. Kamakoti's mission went beyond creating processors; it involved empowering students and contributing to the nation's growth. He became closely associated with the National Security Advisory Board, where he had the privilege of working alongside Ajit Doval, the National Security Advisor (NSA) to the Prime Minister of India and P.S. Raghavan, the Chairman of National Security Advisory Board of India. These experiences provided invaluable insights into the workings of a large democracy and the responsibility that came with it.

Furthermore, Prof. Kamakoti was involved with various financial institutions, serving on committees and boards, such as the Technology Standing Committee for the National Stock Exchange and the board of City Union Bank. Financial insights proved instrumental in his role as Director of IIT Madras.

"I am immensely grateful to the Ministry of Education for entrusting me with the responsibility of the Director of IIT Madras. This institution, as a premier academic entity, had a significant role to play in shaping the future of education in India. They were committed to the cause and had embraced the goals set forth in the National Education Policy 2020."

A major focus area for Prof. Kamakoti's team is to improve the Gross Enrolment Ratio in higher education, which currently stands at 26.2%. Their aim is to raise it to 50% within the next decade. To achieve this, they have initiated rural interaction

centres, bridging the gap between urban and rural students. These centres are equipped with large screens and internet connectivity, allowing students from remote areas to interact with educators and receive academic support. They have established nearly 100 such centres in Tamil Nadu and Uttar Pradesh, offering support and motivation to students in remote areas. Their aspirations extend to setting up 100,000 such centres, and they are actively seeking corporate social responsibility (CSR) support for this noble initiative.

Another noteworthy endeavour is creating IIT Madras's presence in Zanzibar, Tanzania, where they are committed to knowledge sharing without expecting any financial returns. Their goal is to nurture intellectual growth in every corner of the globe.

Prof. Kamakoti's journey has been guided by a deep sense of responsibility towards education, innovation, and contributing to the well-being of the nation. As director of IIT Madras, he and his team have accomplished a lot, including the opening of a medical school, establishing a campus in Tanzania, and launching another BS program in Medical Science and Engineering at IIT Madras campus. While discussing his involvement to ensure the progress of the institute, he acknowledges the need to delegate some responsibilities to free up more time for broader strategic thinking and planning, which is essential for taking their initiatives and country to the next level.

"I always believe that I should not procrastinate things administratively. I also feel that nowadays I do not find enough time to think about the future of the Institute as the administrative load is so high. Therefore, I must figure out a way to create 12 more hours for thinking about the future of the institute." **EFY**



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